

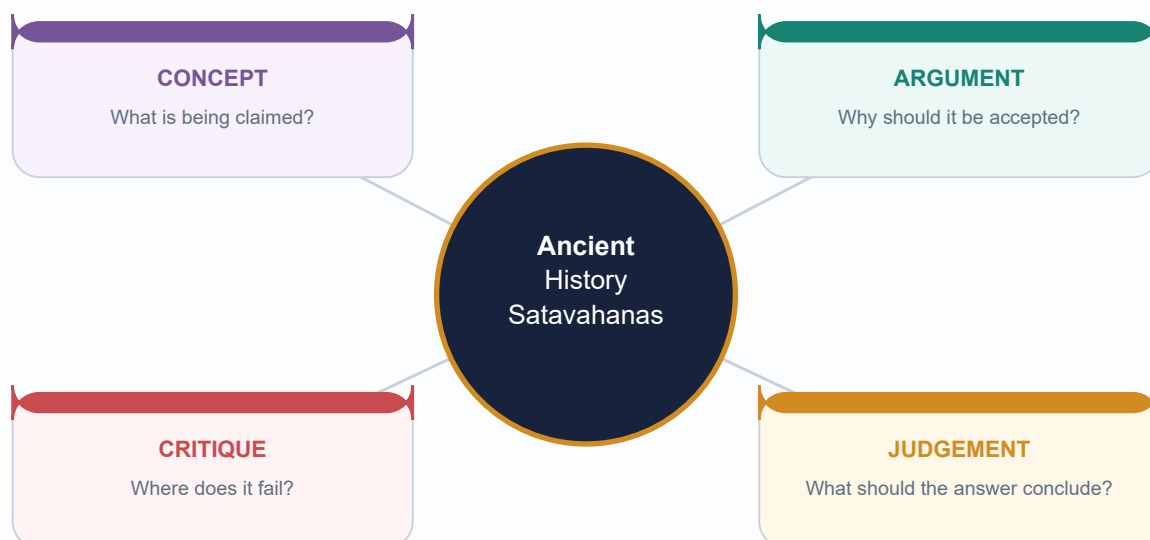
ANCIENT HISTORY SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Ancient History 17 - Satavahanas and Deccan - Solved Workbook

4 verified/routed PYQs | 48 hard MCQs | 12 remedial MCQs

3 each solved 10/15/20-mark Mains | Strict A-B-C-D rotation

Evidence-led answers with explicit key/source caveats



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

PYQ 01 - 2026 Prelims GS-I Q13: Amaravati Stupa

Verified / routed
PYQ Ancient
History 17

KEY DATA

Item	Detail
Status	Official Set-A question verified locally; answer from the locally held provisional 2026 key.
Question	Which statements on the Amaravati Stupa and its relief sculpture are correct? (1) It was located in the lower Krishna valley. (2) In India, it was next only to the Sanchi Stupa in size. (3) The Amaravati school made a lasting impact on later South Indian sculpture, and its products were carried to Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia.
Option 1	A. 2 and 3 only
Option 2	B. 1 only
Option 3	C. 1 and 3 only
Option 4	D. 1, 2 and 3

STATIC THEORY

- **Answer:** C - 1 and 3 only (PROVISIONAL OFFICIAL KEY).
- Statement 1 is correct: Amaravati-Dharanikota lies in the lower Krishna valley.
- Statement 2 is incorrect in the paper's framing. Amaravati was the great Andhra mahachaitya; the statement making it merely next to Sanchi is not accepted by the provisional key.
- Statement 3 is correct: the Andhra/Amaravati visual idiom influenced later southern production, and portable works or stylistic forms travelled to Sri Lanka and wider maritime networks.
- LIMIT: Artistic movement does not prove Satavahana political control over Sri Lanka or Southeast Asia.
- **Why this earns marks:** It uses the provisional key transparently, tests each statement independently and adds the crucial art-circulation versus political-rule distinction.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Question wording verified from the locally held official paper.
2. Key status is stated explicitly and never upgraded silently.

UPSC TRAPS

- WRONG:** An inferred or provisional key can be presented as final official.
- CORRECT:** Keep the exact key status visible.

MAINS ANGLE

Question -> evidence/elimination -> answer -> source or key caveat.

STUDY LINK

Related teaching sections precede this solved PYQ.

HIGH

PYQ 02 - 2023 Prelims GS-I Q41: Dhanyakataka

Verified / routed

PYQ Ancient

History 17

KEY DATA

Item	Detail
Status	Official question verified locally; official answer key unavailable locally. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED; high confidence.
Question	In which region was Dhanyakataka, which flourished as a prominent Buddhist centre under the Mahasanghikas, located?
Option 1	A. Andhra
Option 2	B. Gandhara
Option 3	C. Kalinga
Option 4	D. Magadha

STATIC THEORY

- **Answer:** A - Andhra (INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED).
- Dhanyakataka/Dharanikota belongs to the lower Krishna-Andhra Buddhist landscape associated with Amaravati.
- Gandhara is north-western, Kalinga lies mainly in coastal Odisha, and Magadha belongs to the middle Gangetic region.
- LIMIT: The relationship between named sects, sites and later textual traditions must not be made more uniform than the evidence permits.
- **Why this earns marks:** It solves through regional sacred geography and clearly labels the unavailable official key.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Question wording verified from the locally held official paper.
2. Key status is stated explicitly and never upgraded silently.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: An inferred or provisional key can be presented as final official.

CORRECT: Keep the exact key status visible.

MAINS ANGLE

Question -> evidence/elimination -> answer -> source or key caveat.

STUDY LINK

Related teaching sections precede this solved PYQ.

HIGH

PYQ 03 - 2020 GS-I Mains Q1: rock-cut architecture

Verified / routed

PYQ Ancient

History 17

KEY DATA

Item	Detail
Status	Official printed Mains question verified from the locally held UPSC paper.
Question	The rock-cut architecture represents one of the most important sources of our knowledge of early Indian art and history. Discuss. (10 marks, 150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- **Answer:** Model answer

- Direct thesis: Rock-cut monuments are durable archives because architecture, images and inscriptions preserve institutions, technology, routes and patronage that literary narratives often omit.

- Claim and evidence: Barabar caves donated by Ashoka and Dasharatha to Ajivikas show early royal patronage and polished-stone skill; they also warn against equating rock-cut architecture only with Buddhism.

- Claim and evidence: Bhaja, Karla and Nashik chaitya-viharas reveal congregational halls, monastic cells and changing scale. Karla's merchant and Yavana donors connect art with route society, while Nashik inscriptions of Ushavadata and Gautamiputra record rival rule, endowments and land rights.

- Claim and evidence: Ajanta's early chaityas and later paintings document long religious and artistic change, not one dynastic moment.

- Qualification: Caves privilege patrons and durable religious institutions; they must be phased carefully and checked against settlements, coins and texts.

- Conclusion: Rock-cut sites are therefore combined architectural, epigraphic and social archives rather than monuments of style alone.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers why caves are sources, uses four named evidence clusters, explains what each proves and closes with a methodological limitation.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Question wording verified from the locally held official paper.
2. Key status is stated explicitly and never upgraded silently.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: An inferred or provisional key can be presented as final official.

CORRECT: Keep the exact key status visible.

MAINS ANGLE

Question -> evidence/elimination -> answer -> source or key caveat.

STUDY LINK

Related teaching sections precede this solved PYQ.

HIGH

PYQ 04 - 2023 Prelims GS-I Q42: stupa origin and function

Verified / routed
PYQ Ancient
History 17

KEY DATA

Item	Detail
Status	Official question verified locally; official answer key unavailable locally. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED; high confidence.
Question	With reference to ancient India, consider: (1) the concept of Stupa is Buddhist in origin; (2) Stupa was generally a repository of relics; (3) Stupa was a votive and commemorative structure in Buddhist tradition. How many statements are correct?
Option 1	A. Only one
Option 2	B. Only two
Option 3	C. All three
Option 4	D. None

STATIC THEORY

- **Answer:** B - Only two (INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED).
- Statement 1 is incorrect: funerary mound traditions pre-date or extend beyond Buddhism, although Buddhism transformed and greatly expanded the stupa.
- Statement 2 is correct as a general statement: many Buddhist stupas enshrined corporeal or associated relics, though not every stupa necessarily did so.
- Statement 3 is correct: Buddhist stupas also served votive and commemorative functions.
- Satavahana link: Amaravati was a mahachaitya with a long architectural and sculptural sequence; its history must not be reduced to a relic container alone.
- **Why this earns marks:** It evaluates every statement independently, distinguishes origin from Buddhist development and applies the result to Amaravati without overgeneralizing.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Question wording verified from the locally held official paper.
2. Key status is stated explicitly and never upgraded silently.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: An inferred or provisional key can be presented as final official.

CORRECT: Keep the exact key status visible.

MAINS ANGLE

Question -> evidence/elimination -> answer -> source or key caveat.

STUDY LINK

Related teaching sections precede this solved PYQ.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 01**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which description best captures the Satavahana polity?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A layered Deccan kingdom working through officials, local chiefs and institutional networks.
B	A uniformly centralized bureaucracy across the peninsula.
C	A stateless merchant federation.
D	A purely coastal thalassocracy.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - A layered Deccan kingdom working through officials, local chiefs and institutional networks.
- **Explanation:** Aharas and officers existed, but maharathis, mahabhojas and local families show uneven and negotiated sovereignty.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 02**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which source combination is most appropriate for Satavahana chronology?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Only Puranic lists.
B	Puranic lists, inscriptions, coins and archaeology read together.
C	Only the Gatha Sattasai.
D	Only Roman geographical texts.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Puranic lists, inscriptions, coins and archaeology read together.

- **Explanation:** No single source supplies a continuous and uncontested chronology.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 03

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the safest identification of Simuka?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	The Kshatrapa defeated by Gautamiputra.
B	The author of the Junagadh inscription.
C	The conventional founder in the dynastic sequence, with disputed absolute date and core.
D	The last Satavahana ruler.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - The conventional founder in the dynastic sequence, with disputed absolute date and core.
- **Explanation:** Simuka heads the usual sequence, but the start date and original locus remain debated.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 04

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why is Naneghat politically important?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It was the principal Ikshvaku capital.
B	It contains Ashoka's major rock edicts.
C	It was a Roman colony.
D	It joined a strategic pass with royal portraits, genealogy and Brahmanical ritual claims.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - It joined a strategic pass with royal portraits, genealogy and Brahmanical ritual claims.
- **Explanation:** The pass made genealogy and ritual visible on a coast-plateau corridor.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 05

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about Naganika is correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	She is associated with the Naneghat record and major royal ritual claims.
B	She was Nahapana's daughter.
C	She composed the Junagadh Sanskrit prashasti.
D	She founded the Ikshvaku dynasty.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - She is associated with the Naneghat record and major royal ritual claims.
- **Explanation:** Naganika/Nayanika demonstrates royal women's authority without proving female succession.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 06**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

The term ahara in Satavahana records refers most safely to:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A Buddhist relic mound.
B	A large administrative division or district.
C	A coin-minting guild.
D	A Vedic sacrifice.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - A large administrative division or district.

- **Explanation:** Ahara is administrative vocabulary but does not prove Mauryan-level centralization.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 07

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What do maharathis and mahabhojas demonstrate?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	The disappearance of local authority.
B	A standardized imperial civil service.
C	The continuing importance of local ruling elites within Satavahana networks.
D	Roman control of Deccan ports.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - The continuing importance of local ruling elites within Satavahana networks.
- **Explanation:** Their donations, coins and marriage ties show incorporation rather than replacement.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 08

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which pairing is correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Rudradaman - Satavahana.
B	Gautamiputra - Ikshvaku.
C	Pulumavi - Kushana.
D	Nahapana - Kshaharata Kshatrapa.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Nahapana - Kshaharata Kshatrapa.
- **Explanation:** Nahapana belonged to the Kshaharata line; Rudradaman was Kardamaka.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 09**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

The main strategic issue in Satavahana-Kshatrapa conflict was:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Changing control of western Deccan routes, Konkan access and ports.
B	Control of the Kaveri delta alone.
C	Conquest of Bactria.
D	Possession of Pataliputra throughout the period.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - Changing control of western Deccan routes, Konkan access and ports.
- **Explanation:** Ports and passes made the western frontier economically and politically valuable.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 10**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why are Gautamiputra's Nahapana overstrikes important?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	They prove all Indian trade used silver.
B	They materially corroborate political defeat and appropriation of usable silver stock.
C	They show the dynasty issued no other metal.
D	They date every Satavahana ruler precisely.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - They materially corroborate political defeat and appropriation of usable silver stock.

- **Explanation:** Overstrikes are powerful event evidence but not complete frontier maps.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 11

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Who composed the best-known posthumous eulogy of Gautamiputra?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Queen Naganika.
B	Rudradaman.
C	His mother Gautami Balashri.
D	Ushavadata.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - His mother Gautami Balashri.

- **Explanation:** The Nashik prashasti is a maternal dynastic eulogy engraved during Pulumavi's reign.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 12

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Gautamiputra's claim to prevent varna mixture should be read as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Proof of complete endogamy.
B	Evidence that merchants disappeared.
C	A Buddhist monastic rule.
D	Royal Brahmanical ideology rather than a demographic census.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Royal Brahmanical ideology rather than a demographic census.
- **Explanation:** Prashasti language articulates desired order and political legitimacy.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 13**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement on Vasisthiputra Pulumavi is safest?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	His coins in Andhra indicate a strong eastern Deccan phase.
B	He permanently destroyed all Kshatrapas.
C	He was the founder Simuka's brother.
D	He wrote the Periplus.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - His coins in Andhra indicate a strong eastern Deccan phase.
- **Explanation:** Coin finds support eastern presence while western conflict continued.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 14**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription is useful because it:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Is a neutral Satavahana tax register.
B	Provides a rival prashasti claiming victories over a Satakarni and western territorial power.
C	Proves no matrimonial ties existed.
D	Was written in Tamil-Brahmi.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Provides a rival prashasti claiming victories over a Satakarni and western territorial power.

- **Explanation:** Rival royal evidence checks unilateral dynastic narratives.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 15

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Yajna Sri Satakarni's ship coins most safely indicate:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A documented oceanic empire.
B	The absence of inland trade.
C	Maritime symbolism and commercial orientation.
D	Roman political control.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Maritime symbolism and commercial orientation.
- **Explanation:** A ship motif is meaningful but cannot measure fleet size or monopoly.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 16

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What best describes Satavahana decline?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	An instant collapse caused only by Rome.
B	A single invasion that erased Deccan towns.
C	A peaceful merger into the Kushana Empire.
D	Regional fragmentation under dynastic, Kshatrapa and local pressures with institutional continuity.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Regional fragmentation under dynastic, Kshatrapa and local pressures with institutional continuity.
- **Explanation:** Multiple causes and regional successors are safer than a monocausal fall.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 17**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which crop-process is a high-yield Deccan marker?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Paddy transplantation in suitable Krishna-Godavari zones.
B	Tea plantations.
C	New World maize.
D	Plantation rubber.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - Paddy transplantation in suitable Krishna-Godavari zones.
- **Explanation:** Wet-rice intensification supported selected eastern agrarian regions.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 18

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which evidence best supports Deccan metalworking?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Only Pliny's army figures.
B	Iron artefacts, slag, forges and a blacksmith workshop at sites such as Peddabankur.
C	Only royal genealogies.
D	Only the Gatha Sattasai.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Iron artefacts, slag, forges and a blacksmith workshop at sites such as Peddabankur.

- **Explanation:** Archaeology directly records production technology.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 19

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the key caution about Satavahana land grants?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	They did not involve land.
B	They were all made to Roman traders.
C	Early grants and immunities should not be equated automatically with mature feudalism.
D	They begin only after the Guptas.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Early grants and immunities should not be equated automatically with mature feudalism.
- **Explanation:** The records are early and important, but scale and standardization grew later.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 20

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which donor must be distinguished as Kshatrpa rather than Satavahana?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Gautami Balashri.
B	Naganika.
C	Yajna Sri Satakarni.
D	Ushavadata.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Ushavadata.
- **Explanation:** Ushavadata, Nahapana's son-in-law, made major Nashik and Karla donations.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

- WRONG:** Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.
- CORRECT:** Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 21

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Akshaya-nivi refers to:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A perpetual endowment preserving the principal.
B	A military camp.
C	A matronymic.
D	A ship-type coin.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - A perpetual endowment preserving the principal.
- **Explanation:** The term is important for institutional finance and durable pious endowments.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 22**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why are guild endowments historically important?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	They prove monasteries minted all coins.
B	They show corporate bodies acting as trusted managers of recurring funds.
C	They abolished royal taxation.
D	They were only hereditary priesthoods.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - They show corporate bodies acting as trusted managers of recurring funds.

- **Explanation:** Nashik-Junnar records connect economic corporations and religious support.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 23

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which site yielded thousands of Satavahana coins and possible mint evidence?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Barabar.
B	Sarnath.
C	Peddabankur.
D	Uttaramerur.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Peddabankur.

- **Explanation:** Peddabankur also had wells and a blacksmith workshop.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 24

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Bhokardan is especially useful for studying:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Only Vedic sacrifice.
B	Only Harappan drainage.
C	Only Gupta temples.
D	A route-town with bead, shell, ivory and metal crafts.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - A route-town with bead, shell, ivory and metal crafts.
- **Explanation:** Its craft debris and route position illuminate urban production.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 25**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which inland towns are named by the Periplus in the western Deccan network?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Paithana and Tagara.
B	Puhar and Korkai only.
C	Taxila and Purushapura.
D	Nalanda and Rajagriha.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - Paithana and Tagara.
- **Explanation:** Paithan and Ter were connected to western maritime outlets.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 26

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

The safest claim about Roman coins in the Deccan is:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	They prove universal Roman legal tender.
B	They demonstrate contact and could function as coin, bullion, hoard or imported object depending on context.
C	They date every site to the issuing emperor's reign.
D	They show Roman colonies ruled the interior.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - They demonstrate contact and could function as coin, bullion, hoard or imported object depending on context.

- **Explanation:** Context determines use; arrival could be later than minting.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 27

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement best bounds Indo-Roman trade?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It was a direct two-state treaty system.
B	It replaced agriculture.
C	It was one strand within wider internal, Arabian Sea, Red Sea and Indian Ocean exchange.
D	It ended all barter.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - It was one strand within wider internal, Arabian Sea, Red Sea and Indian Ocean exchange.
- **Explanation:** Multiple intermediaries and internal production must remain visible.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 28

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Satavahana lead coinage is significant because it:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Proves technological inferiority.
B	Was the only coinage in India.
C	Was imported from Rome.
D	Reflects regional monetary practice and Deccan mineral availability.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Reflects regional monetary practice and Deccan mineral availability.
- **Explanation:** Metal choice must be interpreted regionally, not ranked as simple progress.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 29

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which reading of coin distribution is methodologically correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It must be cross-checked with mint, hoard, stratigraphy, inscriptions and trade movement.
B	It directly draws political borders.
C	It proves personal royal religion.
D	It measures population.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - It must be cross-checked with mint, hoard, stratigraphy, inscriptions and trade movement.
- **Explanation:** Coins circulate beyond political control and can be redeposited.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 30**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Matronymics such as Gautamiputra indicate:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A proven matriarchal constitution.
B	Maternal lineage or gotra significance within a basically patrilineal dynasty.
C	Election by Buddhist nuns.
D	Absence of royal marriage.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Maternal lineage or gotra significance within a basically patrilineal dynasty.

- **Explanation:** Royal women's authority and matronymics do not equal female-line succession.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 31

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which royal woman is linked to Gautamiputra's Nashik eulogy?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Naganika.
B	Sanghamitta.
C	Gautami Balashri.
D	Prabhavati Gupta.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Gautami Balashri.- **Explanation:** Gautami Balashri fashioned the posthumous memory of her son.- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.**CORRECT:** Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 32

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Donor inscriptions of merchants and artisans most directly show:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Complete equality in society.
B	The disappearance of agriculture.
C	A census of all workers.
D	Public religious participation, surplus and occupational identity among visible donors.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Public religious participation, surplus and occupational identity among visible donors.
- **Explanation:** The record is valuable but biased toward resource-holding donors.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 33**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

The term gandhika is associated with:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Perfumers or a wider shopkeeper identity in later usage.
B	Village headmen.
C	Military camps.
D	Royal mothers.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - Perfumers or a wider shopkeeper identity in later usage.
- **Explanation:** Perfumers repeatedly appear among donors in the early historic record.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 34

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which formulation best describes Satavahana religion?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Exclusive state Buddhism.
B	Brahmanical royal legitimation coexisted with Buddhist patronage and diverse donors.
C	Exclusive rejection of Vedic rites.
D	No institutional patronage.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Brahmanical royal legitimation coexisted with Buddhist patronage and diverse donors.

- **Explanation:** Naneghat sacrifices and Nashik Buddhist grants must be held together.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 35

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What does a Buddhist donation by a ruler prove?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	The population's only religion.
B	Abolition of Brahmanical ritual.
C	Patronage and institutional support, not necessarily exclusive private conversion.
D	Monastic control of the state.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Patronage and institutional support, not necessarily exclusive private conversion.
- **Explanation:** Patronage could serve merit, legitimacy, alliances and route society.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 36

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which language-script pairing is correct for Satavahana inscriptions?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Sanskrit in Kharoshthi only.
B	Tamil in Greek script.
C	Pali in cuneiform.
D	Prakrit in Brahmi.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Prakrit in Brahmi.
- **Explanation:** Prakrit-Brahmi is the standard epigraphic association.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.
CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 37

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Gatha Sattasai is:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A Prakrit anthology attributed to Hala but subject to later compilation and retouching.
B	A contemporary Greek chronicle.
C	Gautamiputra's tax code.
D	Rudradaman's inscription.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - A Prakrit anthology attributed to Hala but subject to later compilation and retouching.
- **Explanation:** Attribution and final textual form must be separated.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 38**

**Solved
objective
practice** Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement distinguishes Karla correctly?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It is only a Satavahana palace.
B	It is a major chaitya with diverse merchant, Yavana and elite patronage.
C	It is an Ikshvaku brick temple.
D	It contains the Hathigumpha inscription.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - It is a major chaitya with diverse merchant, Yavana and elite patronage.

- **Explanation:** Karla is a multi-donor Buddhist cave complex on a western route.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 39

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Nashik caves are especially valuable because they preserve:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Only Mauryan edicts.
B	Only Gupta copper plates.
C	Kshatrapa and Satavahana inscriptions, grants and monastic architecture.
D	Only Sangam poetry.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Kshatrapa and Satavahana inscriptions, grants and monastic architecture.
- **Explanation:** Rival political phases and donor records share the same landscape.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 40

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

A chaitya is best defined as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A monastic cell block only.
B	A royal coin mint.
C	A village tax unit.
D	A congregational worship hall, usually with a stupa in Buddhist cave contexts.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - A congregational worship hall, usually with a stupa in Buddhist cave contexts.
- **Explanation:** Chaitya and vihara must not be confused.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 41**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement on Amaravati is correct?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It was a lower Krishna mahachaitya with a long, multi-phase history.
B	It was founded only in the Ikshvaku period.
C	It stood in Gandhara.
D	It had no urban context.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - It was a lower Krishna mahachaitya with a long, multi-phase history.
- **Explanation:** Its sequence begins early and crosses dynastic boundaries.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 42**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Ayaka pillars are associated especially with:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	All Gandharan monasteries.
B	Some Andhra stupa traditions at the cardinal points.
C	Every Satavahana coin.
D	Mauryan court halls.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Some Andhra stupa traditions at the cardinal points.

- **Explanation:** They are important but not universal even within Andhra.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 43

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the safest description of Amaravati influence?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Satavahanas conquered Southeast Asia.
B	Sri Lankan art was an exact copy.
C	Artistic and Buddhist forms circulated toward Sri Lanka and wider maritime Asia.
D	Only Roman artists produced the reliefs.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Artistic and Buddhist forms circulated toward Sri Lanka and wider maritime Asia.
- **Explanation:** Cultural movement does not imply political rule or passive imitation.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 44

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why must Nagarjunakonda be bounded in this topic?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It has no Buddhist remains.
B	It lies in the western Deccan.
C	It predates all Satavahanas by millennia.
D	Its greatest monumental phase belongs mainly to Ikshvaku successor patronage.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Its greatest monumental phase belongs mainly to Ikshvaku successor patronage.
- **Explanation:** It belongs to the broader Andhra landscape but is not simply a Satavahana site.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 45**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which answer best explains Satavahana connective significance?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	They linked plateau agriculture, inland towns, western/eastern coasts and north-south cultural routes.
B	They isolated the Deccan.
C	They depended on one port.
D	They abolished local elites.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - They linked plateau agriculture, inland towns, western/eastern coasts and north-south cultural routes.
- **Explanation:** Connectivity is the dynasty's core historical contribution.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 46

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which source is least suitable as a literal administrative census?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A dated land-grant inscription.
B	Pliny's statement about Andhra towns and army numbers.
C	A stratified mint context.
D	A labelled royal inscription.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Pliny's statement about Andhra towns and army numbers.

- **Explanation:** External numerical claims require genre and transmission caution.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 47

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the best 20-mark thesis?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	The dynasty mattered only for one victory over Nahapana.
B	Roman trade fully explains its rise and fall.
C	Satavahana power was a layered Deccan network joining agrarian, commercial and religious nodes, with uneven territorial control.
D	Matronymics prove a matriarchal empire.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Satavahana power was a layered Deccan network joining agrarian, commercial and religious nodes, with uneven territorial control.
- **Explanation:** The thesis accommodates polity, economy, society, culture and source limits.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.
CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 48

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What should a source-critical conclusion emphasize?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	One source must always be accepted literally.
B	Debate makes history impossible.
C	Coin finds replace all inscriptions.
D	Convergence among inscriptions, coins, archaeology and texts, while preserving their different limits.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Convergence among inscriptions, coins, archaeology and texts, while preserving their different limits.
- **Explanation:** Triangulation produces graded confidence rather than certainty or skepticism.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 49

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Satavahana chronology should be written as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Broad phases with source-specific dates and explicit debate.
B	One universally fixed genealogy.
C	Only a Puranic total.
D	Only the reign of Gautamiputra.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - Broad phases with source-specific dates and explicit debate.
- **Explanation:** Chronology is reconstructed and must remain qualified.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 50**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: 'Andhra' in the Puranas means:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A Roman province.
B	A dynastic/regional identification requiring interpretation, not automatic proof of one origin.
C	A Buddhist sect.
D	A fixed capital name.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - A dynastic/regional identification requiring interpretation, not automatic proof of one origin.

- **Explanation:** Puranic and epigraphic naming do not align perfectly.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 51

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Gautamiputra's varna claim is:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A population census.
B	An archaeological layer.
C	A royal ideological statement.
D	A guild contract.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - A royal ideological statement.
- **Explanation:** Prashasti rhetoric is evidence for kingship ideals.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 52

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Matronymic does not mean:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Maternal association.
B	Gotra relevance.
C	Parentage identification.
D	Matriarchy.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Matriarchy.
- **Explanation:** Succession remained substantially patrilineal.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 53**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Ushavadata was:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Nahapana's son-in-law and a Kshatrapa donor.
B	A Satavahana founder.
C	An Ikshvaku king.
D	A Roman merchant.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - Nahapana's son-in-law and a Kshatrapa donor.
- **Explanation:** Correct patron identification prevents mixing rival archives.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 54**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Nahapana overstrikes prove most securely:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Permanent control of all western India.
B	Gautamiputra's political victory and currency reuse in a regional context.
C	Universal silver coinage.
D	The end of barter.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Gautamiputra's political victory and currency reuse in a regional context.

- **Explanation:** The evidence is strong but bounded.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 55

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Satavahana prosperity was based on:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Roman trade alone.
B	Land grants alone.
C	Agriculture, crafts, internal routes and external exchange together.
D	War booty alone.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Agriculture, crafts, internal routes and external exchange together.
- **Explanation:** A multi-base economy avoids dependency narratives.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 56

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Karla and Nashik show:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	One exclusive royal religion.
B	Absence of merchants.
C	No political competition.
D	Multi-donor Buddhist institutions connected to route society.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Multi-donor Buddhist institutions connected to route society.
- **Explanation:** Their inscriptions preserve rulers, chiefs, merchants and artisans.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 57**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Amaravati should be dated as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A long multi-phase monument spanning more than one dynasty.
B	One building campaign of Yajna Sri.
C	Only Mauryan.
D	Only Ikshvaku.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** A - A long multi-phase monument spanning more than one dynasty.
- **Explanation:** Its development cannot be compressed into one reign.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 58**

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Ship coins of Yajna Sri indicate:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A documented overseas empire.
B	Maritime orientation and symbolism.
C	No inland economy.
D	Roman suzerainty.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** B - Maritime orientation and symbolism.

- **Explanation:** Iconography must not be overextended.

- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 59

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: The best polity label is:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Centralized empire with identical administration.
B	Stateless tribal zone.
C	Layered or network polity with real but uneven royal power.
D	Foreign colony.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** C - Layered or network polity with real but uneven royal power.
- **Explanation:** The label integrates offices, chiefs, grants and routes.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 60

Solved
objective
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Remedial: Evidence in a Mains answer should follow:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Name-list -> quotation -> conclusion.
B	Chronology only.
C	Opinion without source.
D	Claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation.

STATIC THEORY

- **Correct answer:** D - Claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation.
- **Explanation:** The sequence converts factual recall into examiner-grade analysis.
- **Why distractors fail:** Each wrong option centralizes too much, crosses a dynasty/source, removes a chronology caveat or turns a qualified inference into an absolute.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strict answer rotation follows A -> B -> C -> D across the complete 60-question sequence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Ignore absolute or source-confusing wording.

CORRECT: Test dynasty, source class, region and chronology independently.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective loop: decide -> justify -> eliminate -> state one limit.

STUDY LINK

Review the owning teaching section if the evidence chain is unclear.

HIGH**Mains 10M-1 - Network polity**

**Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17**

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why is the Satavahana state better described as a layered or network polity than as a uniformly centralized empire? (10 marks, 150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: Satavahana kings exercised substantial military and fiscal power, but their realm was integrated through graded authority rather than one uniform bureaucracy.
- Claim and evidence: Aharas, amatyas, mahamatras and gramikas show royal administration. Significance: the crown could divide territory, issue records and work through officials. Limit: shared vocabulary with Mauryas does not prove identical administrative depth.
- Claim and evidence: Maharathis and mahabhojas appear as cave donors, coin-issuing local elites and matrimonial partners. Significance: royal power enclosed existing lineages instead of eliminating them. Limit: their precise legal rank varied by place and time.
- Claim and evidence: Kura, Ananda and Sada families plus mobile kataka or skandhavara centres indicate differentiated control. Significance: sovereignty depended on local anchorage and movement.
- Conclusion: The Satavahana realm was therefore a powerful but uneven network connecting court, chiefs, villages, routes and religious institutions.
- **Why this earns marks:** It supplies three named evidence units, explains what each proves, qualifies the centralization claim and gives a direct verdict suited to 10 marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every named evidence unit is attached to a claim and a significance or limitation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List rulers or sites without argument.

CORRECT: Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limit.

MAINS ANGLE

Demand fidelity, evidence density, balance and a reasoned verdict.

STUDY LINK

Use the final register PYQ spine for timed compression.

HIGH**Mains 10M-2 - Nahapana overstrikes**

**Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17**

INTRO & ORIGIN

Assess the historical value of Gautamiputra Satakarni's overstrikes on Nahapana's coins. (10 marks, 150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: The overstrikes are unusually strong material evidence for political reversal, but they are not a complete territorial map.
- Claim and evidence: The Jogalthambi hoard near Nashik contained more than 8,000 Nahapana silver coins in RS Sharma's account, many restruck by Gautamiputra. Significance: the new ruler appropriated an existing currency stock while replacing Kshaharata authority.
- Claim and evidence: Gautamiputra's Nashik inscriptions and Gautami Balashri's prashasti call him exterminator of the Kshaharatas. Significance: numismatics independently supports the dynastic victory claim.
- Claim and evidence: A Gautamiputra grant concerns land formerly under Ushavadata's jurisdiction. Significance: conquest altered fiscal and institutional control, not only coin imagery.
- Qualification: Overstriking may also reflect metal economy and currency continuity; it cannot establish the duration or exact frontier of restored rule.
- Conclusion: Read together, coin, inscription and grant form a high-confidence but regionally bounded reconstruction.
- **Why this earns marks:** It triangulates coin, prashasti and grant evidence and explicitly separates strong event proof from weak border inference.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every named evidence unit is attached to a claim and a significance or limitation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List rulers or sites without argument.

CORRECT: Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limit.

MAINS ANGLE

Demand fidelity, evidence density, balance and a reasoned verdict.

STUDY LINK

Use the final register PYQ spine for timed compression.

HIGH

Mains 10M-3 - Matronymics and women

Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

What do Satavahana matronymics and inscriptions reveal about royal women? (10 marks, 150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: Satavahana evidence gives royal women unusual genealogical and donor visibility, but it does not establish matriarchy.
- Claim and evidence: Names such as Gautamiputra and Vasisthiputra associate kings with the mother's gotra or parentage. Significance: maternal lineage mattered in a polygynous and alliance-based court. Limit: kings still succeeded through a male dynastic line.
- Claim and evidence: Naganika's Naneghat inscription records genealogy, sacrifices and lavish dakshina. Significance: a queen could shape ritual legitimacy and public royal memory.
- Claim and evidence: Gautami Balashri's Nashik inscription eulogizes her deceased son. Significance: the king's mother became an authoritative dynastic voice.
- Claim and evidence: Women donors and the Nashik woman doorkeeper Lota widen the archive beyond queens. Limit: inscription-making privileges resource-holding women.
- Conclusion: The evidence reveals significant female agency within, not outside, a patriarchal political order.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers both matronymics and inscriptional agency, uses more than three precise examples and avoids the matriarchy trap.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every named evidence unit is attached to a claim and a significance or limitation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List rulers or sites without argument.

CORRECT: Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limit.

MAINS ANGLE

Demand fidelity, evidence density, balance and a reasoned verdict.

STUDY LINK

Use the final register PYQ spine for timed compression.

HIGH

Mains 15M-1 - Chronology, genealogy and political geography

Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss the principal problems in reconstructing Satavahana chronology, genealogy and political geography. (15 marks, 250 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: Satavahana sequence is recoverable in broad phases, but exact dates, origins, capitals and borders remain debated because the archives are discontinuous and differently motivated.
- Puranic problem: Matsya and Brahmanda traditions list about 30 kings and long duration, while Vayu and shorter reconstructions differ. Significance: they preserve dynastic memory. Limit: recension, total years and Andhra-bhritya interpretation are contested.
- Epigraphic anchor: Naneghat labels Simuka, Naganika, Satakarni and princes; Nashik records anchor Gautamiputra and Pulumavi. Significance: contemporary names and relationships. Limit: damage and prashasti form prevent a complete genealogy.
- Numismatic anchor: early coins at Kotalingala and Sangareddy support an eastern-origin hypothesis; Naneghat-Nashik inscriptions support western beginnings; later coin-only rulers are absent from Puranic lists. Significance: coins fill textual gaps. Limit: circulation is not identical to political core.
- Political-geography control: Gautami Balashri lists many lands, Gautamiputra restrikes Nahapana, and Rudradaman's Junagadh prashasti claims western victories. Together they show wide but shifting power. Limit: universal claims and rival eulogies cannot be literalized.
- Capital problem: Pratishthana was a major western centre; Dharanikota-Dhanyakataka became important in the eastern phase. A single permanent-capital model is unsafe.
- Conclusion: The most credible reconstruction uses broad ranges and a moving map built from convergent evidence, not one harmonized king-list.
- **Why this earns marks:** It uses five evidence clusters across every part of the demand, distinguishes source strengths and gives a methodologically reasoned verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every named evidence unit is attached to a claim and a significance or limitation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List rulers or sites without argument.

CORRECT: Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limit.

MAINS ANGLE

Demand fidelity, evidence density, balance and a reasoned verdict.

STUDY LINK

Use the final register PYQ spine for timed compression.

HIGH

Mains 15M-2 - Agrarian economy, grants and urban growth

Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analyse the relationship among agrarian expansion, land grants, crafts and towns in the Satavahana Deccan. (15 marks, 250 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: Satavahana urban and political growth rested on interaction between productive rural zones, transferable fiscal rights, specialized crafts and route-linked towns.
- Agrarian claim and evidence: socketed hoes, ploughshares, sickles and iron-working at Peddabankur and other sites support intensified cultivation. Paddy transplantation and the Krishna-Godavari rice zone increased surplus, while cotton fed textile production. Limit: tools and crop references do not quantify output across the entire plateau.
- Settlement claim and evidence: Peddabankur's wells, drains, possible mint and blacksmith workshop; Dhulikatta's fortification; Bhokardan's bead, shell, ivory and metal debris reveal differentiated towns. Significance: towns concentrated production, exchange and administration.
- Grant claim and evidence: Naganika's Naneghat record includes villages in dakshina; Gautamiputra's Nashik field grant exempted monks from royal entry, salt digging and district interference. Significance: the state transferred revenue and jurisdictional rights. Limit: this is an early template, not proof of mature feudalism.
- Guild claim and evidence: Ushavadata's investment with Govardhana weavers and Junnar corporate donations show guilds managing recurring resources for monasteries. Though Kshatrapa evidence, it belongs to the same western Deccan institutional field.
- Conclusion: Agriculture supplied the base, crafts and routes generated nodal towns, and grants reorganized surplus and authority; none of these mechanisms worked in isolation.
- **Why this earns marks:** It integrates five named evidence units into one causal chain and explicitly distinguishes Kshatrapa evidence and later-feudal overstatement.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every named evidence unit is attached to a claim and a significance or limitation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List rulers or sites without argument.

CORRECT: Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limit.

MAINS ANGLE

Demand fidelity, evidence density, balance and a reasoned verdict.

STUDY LINK

Use the final register PYQ spine for timed compression.

HIGH

Mains 15M-3 - Plural patronage

Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

How did Brahmanical legitimization and Buddhist patronage coexist under the Satavahanas? (15 marks, 250 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: Brahmanical kingship and Buddhist patronage were complementary strategies operating through different institutions, audiences and forms of merit.
- Brahmanical claim and evidence: Naganika's Naneghat inscription invokes deities and records rajasuya, two ashvamedhas and lavish dakshina. Significance: shrauta ritual established royal sovereignty and alliance with Brahmanas. Limit: it describes elite ideology, not exclusive social religion.
- Royal ideology claim and evidence: Gautami Balashri calls Gautamiputra a peerless Brahmana and restorer of varna order. Significance: Brahmanical identity answered political competition. Limit: the eulogy cannot be treated as a demographic fact.
- Buddhist claim and evidence: Gautamiputra granted a Nashik field to monks with fiscal immunities; western caves preserve Satavahana, Kshatrapa, merchant and artisan gifts. Significance: rulers and social groups supported durable route-side institutions.
- Donor-network claim and evidence: Karla's merchants and Yavanas, Junnar guilds and Nashik endowments show that Buddhist establishments drew support beyond the court. Significance: monasteries became nodes of merit, identity and social trust. Limit: patronage does not prove conversion.
- Art claim and evidence: Amaravati's mahachaitya and western chaitya-viharas materialized cumulative patronage across phases. Limit: not every monument or later Andhra development was Satavahana.
- Conclusion: Satavahana plural patronage joined Brahmanical royal legitimacy to socially broad Buddhist institutions without creating a single state religion.
- **Why this earns marks:** It uses six evidence units, differentiates ideology from patronage and includes donor, regional and chronological limits.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every named evidence unit is attached to a claim and a significance or limitation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List rulers or sites without argument.

CORRECT: Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limit.

MAINS ANGLE

Demand fidelity, evidence density, balance and a reasoned verdict.

STUDY LINK

Use the final register PYQ spine for timed compression.

HIGH

Mains 20M-1 - Deccan bridge

Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Satavahanas connected north and south, coast and interior, agrarian production and long-distance exchange. Critically examine. (20 marks, 250 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: Satavahana significance was connective, but the connections formed a regionally uneven network rather than a uniformly controlled commercial empire.
- Geography and evidence: Naneghat linked the Konkan coast to the plateau, while the Godavari route joined Pratishthana, Tagara and eastern zones. Significance: passes and river valleys translated terrain into political and commercial nodes. Limit: routes changed hands during Kshatrapa conflict.
- Agrarian base and evidence: iron tools, paddy transplantation in Krishna-Godavari zones and cotton production supported surplus and textile exchange. Significance: connectivity rested on hinterland production, not foreign trade alone.
- Urban-craft evidence: Peddabankur's mint, wells and forge; Bhokardan's bead and ivory industries; Adam's coins and moulds show productive inland towns. Limit: excavated centres cannot represent every locality.
- Coastal and overseas evidence: the Periplus names Paithana and Tagara; Roman coins, amphorae and Amaravati's wharf show Indian Ocean-linked contact. Significance: Deccan goods and bullion entered wider circuits. Limit: imports do not prove economic dependence or Roman settlement.
- Political evidence: Gautamiputra's Nahapana overstrikes and Nashik grants show that control of western access had military and fiscal consequences. Rudradaman's recovery proves unstable frontiers.
- Cultural evidence: Prakrit-Brahmi inscriptions, western caves and Amaravati art connected local patrons to wider Buddhist and Brahmanical worlds. Limit: circulation did not mean political conquest of Sri Lanka or Southeast Asia.
- Conclusion: The Satavahanas' achievement was to stabilize and exploit a Deccan web of production, authority and movement; its very nodal character explains both reach and uneven control.
- **Why this earns marks:** It uses more than seven named evidence units across every pair in the question, sustains the critical qualification and ends with a network-based verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every named evidence unit is attached to a claim and a significance or limitation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List rulers or sites without argument.

CORRECT: Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limit.

MAINS ANGLE

Demand fidelity, evidence density, balance and a reasoned verdict.

STUDY LINK

Use the final register PYQ spine for timed compression.

HIGH

Mains 20M-2 - Centralization debate

Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

Critically examine the view that the Satavahanas created a centralized empire in the Deccan. (20 marks, 250 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: The Satavahanas created durable paramountcy and administrative capacity, but centralized-empire language exaggerates territorial uniformity.
- Case for state capacity: aharas, amatyas, mahamatras, mahasenapatis, gramikas, scribes and record keepers demonstrate administrative divisions and documentary government. Kataka and skandhavara show mobile coercive centres. Gautamiputra's grant immunities presuppose officials whose entry could be prohibited.
- Case for military-fiscal reach: the Nahapana overstrikes, recovery of Nashik-Pune areas and wide regional claims in Gautami Balashri's prashasti show that the crown could conquer, redistribute land and communicate sovereignty.
- Counter-evidence from local elites: maharathis and mahabhojas retained donor, matrimonial and probably territorial importance. Kura, Ananda, Sada and other coin-issuing families reveal regional bases not erased by kingship.
- Counter-evidence from political geography: western ports and Malwa changed hands between Satavahanas and Kshatrapas; Pulumavi's eastern strength coexisted with Rudradaman's western recovery. Prashasti horses drinking three oceans are ideology, not an administrative survey.
- Institutional network: Brahmanas, Buddhist monasteries, guilds and merchants received resources and mediated legitimacy. This widened royal influence while dispersing rights and authority.
- Historiographical verdict: B. D. Chattopadhyaya's locality approach and Upinder Singh's evidence support encapsulation of pre-existing elites. Yet network polity must not be confused with weakness: the crown remained the premier war-making and grant-making power.
- Conclusion: The Satavahana state was neither Mauryan centralization nor loose chiefdom; it was a layered Deccan polity with strong nodes and uneven direct rule.
- **Why this earns marks:** It presents both state capacity and counter-evidence, uses administrative, numismatic, inscriptional and local-lineage proof, and gives a graded rather than binary verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every named evidence unit is attached to a claim and a significance or limitation.

UPSC TRAPS

- WRONG:** List rulers or sites without argument.
- CORRECT:** Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limit.

MAINS ANGLE

Demand fidelity, evidence density, balance and a reasoned verdict.

STUDY LINK

Use the final register PYQ spine for timed compression.

HIGH

Mains 20M-3 - Source criticism

Solved Mains
practice Ancient
History 17

INTRO & ORIGIN

How do inscriptions, coins and archaeology together reconstruct Satavahana history, and where do they leave uncertainty? (20 marks, 250 words)

STATIC THEORY

- Direct thesis: Satavahana history is strongest where independent source classes converge and weakest where historians force one source to answer questions outside its capacity.
- Inscriptions: Naneghat supplies Simuka-Satakarni-Naganika genealogy, sacrifices and route-side kingship; Nashik supplies Gautamiputra's eulogy, grants and rival Kshatrapa layers. Significance: names, titles and institutions are contemporary. Limit: damage, formula and prashasti exaggeration.
- Coins: Kotalingala and Sangareddy finds enter the origin debate; Jogalthambi overstrikes corroborate Nahapana's defeat; Pulumavi's eastern and Yajna Sri's wide issues map phases; later coin-only rulers fill king-list gaps. Limit: circulation, hoarding and later movement prevent automatic border drawing.
- Archaeology: Peddabankur, Dhulikatta, Bhokardan, Adam and Dharanikota-Amaravati reveal towns, mints, crafts, drains, fortifications, channels and monasteries. Significance: material life and non-royal actors become visible. Limit: dating, site coverage and ruler attribution remain uneven.
- Texts as controls: Puranas preserve conflicting king-lists; the Periplus identifies routes and markets; Pliny offers Andhra town and army claims. Significance: they widen chronology and economy. Limit: recension, genre and outsider perspective.
- Convergence example: Gautamiputra's victory rests on Nashik claims, overstruck coins and land formerly tied to Ushavadata. This is high-confidence regional history.
- Residual uncertainty: original homeland, absolute chronology, capital sequence, exact frontiers, demographic varna practice and causes of decline remain debated.
- Conclusion: Triangulation yields graded confidence, not a single seamless narrative; uncertainty is a feature of disciplined history, not a defect to be hidden.
- **Why this earns marks:** It is organized by source class, attaches significance and limit to every named item, demonstrates convergence and explicitly identifies unresolved questions.

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